Pupil studio resources & worksheet — Creative practice, studio roles and pathways

Pathway: SUMMIT · Week 2 Part 2 · Big question: How do interdisciplinary creative groups take a structural commission from studio prototype to public installation?

Arrival check

When a major public structure or gallery installation is built, how many different creative and technical careers are involved behind the scenes?

[ ] At least four key roles: the Lead artist/Designer, Structural engineer, Specialist fabricator, and Curator

[ ] Every role relies on clear drawings, maquettes, and material prototypes to communicate

[ ] Understanding studio pathways shows how practical making connects to real creative careers

Starter visual cues

1. Concept artist / Designer: Researches site context, draws elevations, and builds the scale maquette.

2. Structural engineer: Analyses triangulation, joint strength, wind load, and safe mounting.

3. Specialist fabricator: Cuts, laminates, welds, or casts the components and applies surface patina.

4. Exhibition curator / Producer: Manages budget, sightlines, lighting design, and public interpretation.

Vote: Why must a Lead artist and a Specialist fabricator share physical material prototypes (swatches and joint models) rather than only emails?

Studio practice planner

Define your studio role focus, joint prototype, and specification.

Shapes/Focus: Role: Concept & maquette lead, Role: Structural engineer, Role: Surface fabricator, Role: Exhibition curator

Tools/Methods: Prototype: Gusseted truss node, Prototype: Laminated arch crown, Prototype: Slotted beam lock, Prototype: Riveted flange plate

Exit ticket

What is the main purpose of building a physical joint and surface 'prototype' before starting the full-scale relief panel?

[ ] To test and prove that the structural joinery and surface patina recipe work reliably before committing to the full build

[ ] So you never have to build the main panel

[ ] To use up all the glue